

EZTor Original CET4 Practice 02

原创四级模拟卷02 · 对标用户提供的2026年6月第1套 · 尚未真人实测校准

所有报道、调查及人物为原创虚构情境，非真实新闻或研究报告。听力为AI合成配音。试卷与答案册分开，完成前不要查看答案。

Total working time: 125 minutes. Writing 30 / Listening 25 / Reading 40 / Translation 30.

Part I Writing (30 minutes)

Directions: Suppose your university newspaper is inviting submissions on the value of learning a practical skill outside your major. You are now to write an essay for submission. You should explain your view and give an example. You will have 30 minutes to write the essay. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

Write your essay on a separate answer sheet.

Part II Listening (25 minutes)

录音仅播放一遍；题干在录音中播报，试卷仅列选项。音频文件：eztor-cet4-original-002-listening.mp3。

Listen to each recording and choose the best answer from A), B), C) and D).

Section A - News reports

1.

- A) They could not buy tickets at the departure point.
- B) They were asked to wait for staff to count the passengers.
- C) They saw a fault in the equipment used to operate the boat.
- D) They had been told their phone tickets were no longer valid.

2.

- A) Replace phone tickets with tickets sold by hand.
- B) Check the connection at the landing point.
- C) Keep the temporary desk open on every boat.
- D) Introduce an additional charge for delayed payments.

3.

- A) Cleaning made both sections reach the same temperature.
- B) The lighter material was coolest immediately before rain.
- C) The dark section collected less dirt after each cleaning.
- D) Dirt reduced the temperature advantage of the lighter surface.

4.

- A) Students measured the two sections at different times of day.
- B) Its effect on surrounding air has proved greater than expected.
- C) Its maintenance needs and wet-weather performance require further observation.
- D) The six-week trial showed that it was unsuitable for everyday use.

5.

- A) Residents wanted assistance with missing packages.
- B) Delivery firms refused to contribute to the running cost.
- C) The room had too little space for additional deliveries.
- D) Residents preferred to collect parcels only at weekends.

6.

- A) The two assistants working part-time.
- B) Delivery companies serving the district.
- C) Residents who use the room after six.
- D) Shops receiving deliveries on Fridays.

7.

- A) Three evenings chosen separately each week.
- B) Three evenings, including Tuesday and Thursday.
- C) Every weekday except Tuesday and Thursday.
- D) Only the two evenings with the greatest demand.

Section B - Long conversations

8.

- A) The manager could not supply coats before the performance.
- B) The coats exceeded the amount allowed in the budget.
- C) The actors would find the available coats difficult to move in.
- D) The coats did not resemble those needed for the play.

9.

- A) The clothes must be returned before the weekend begins.
- B) A student hire charge must be paid for each coat.
- C) A payment must be held until the coats are returned.
- D) A member of theatre staff must collect the coats afterwards.

10.

- A) He will travel earlier before his Monday class.
- B) He will ask his sister to miss the morning class.
- C) He will leave the coats with the woman on Sunday.
- D) He will return the clothes after the theatre closes.

11.

- A) Confirm the coat reservation with the theatre.
- B) Buy material to replace the remaining scenery.
- C) Obtain the actors' measurements for making hats.
- D) Find a way to pay the deposit from the society account.

12.

- A) The other tenants would share his bus-pass expense.
- B) Heating would cost less than in his current room.
- C) The owner would reduce the rent during winter.
- D) He would exchange transport spending for a higher rent.

13.

- A) It would normally be free by the time he wanted to cook.
- B) The room owner planned to add a second kitchen.
- C) He could change his meals to the tenants' earlier schedule.
- D) The other tenants agreed to eat outside in the evening.

14.

- A) Ask about temporary university accommodation.
- B) Move into the new room before September.
- C) Extend the new agreement by seven days.
- D) Stay in the room his cousin is leaving.

15.

- A) The owner has not yet fixed a date for moving in.
- B) His current contract requires him to stay for another term.
- C) A written charge conflicts with the owner's earlier statement.
- D) His expected transport saving has proved too small.

Section C - Passages

16.

- A) Its noise generally improves a reader's ability to concentrate.
- B) Its customers are less likely to produce unfamiliar words.
- C) Its average sound level is usually lower than that of a corridor.
- D) Its sound pattern may be easier to ignore than isolated speech elsewhere.

17.

- A) Choosing a comfortable seat before beginning work.
- B) Carrying out a familiar practical activity.
- C) Keeping several items of verbal information in mind.
- D) Recognising regular sounds in a known environment.

18.

- A) The material played through them can itself compete for attention.
- B) They make unfamiliar background sounds appear predictable.
- C) They prevent users from noticing any interruption.
- D) They are useful only when no music is played.

19.

- A) Managers planned longer opening hours although demand was unchanged.
- B) Students wanted more courts although evening bookings were falling.
- C) Staff saw crowded courts while students reported unused reservations.
- D) Bookings suggested full use while some courts stood empty.

20.

- A) It would receive a reminder two hours after the session.
- B) Its reserved court would become available to others.
- C) It would be charged for cancelling at short notice.
- D) Its next two bookings would be removed from the system.

21.

- A) The original booking figures understated the need for a larger building.
- B) New facilities were unnecessary because total demand had fallen.
- C) Actual use could rise even when recorded reservations declined.
- D) Advance booking prevented students from using courts at short notice.

22.

- A) They focused on shop closures rather than people at home.
- B) They mainly recorded everyday scenes rather than public occasions.
- C) They usually carried complete names and dates on the back.
- D) They included fewer family members than public officials.

23.

- A) They accepted only pictures whose exact year could be established.
- B) They replaced contributors' memories with volunteers' estimates.
- C) They required agreement on every person before storing a picture.
- D) They allowed information gaps when the source was documented.

24.

- A) Choose one account immediately when memories conflicted.
- B) Limit corrections to photographs without a recorded date.
- C) Follow the person who expressed the greatest confidence.
- D) Give reasons supporting their identification of an image.

25.

- A) Researchers considered private family scenes unsuitable for study.
- B) The archive could not identify the relatives shown in them.
- C) Permission to preserve a copy did not necessarily include public display.
- D) Contributors wanted the originals returned before copies were made.

Part III Reading (40 minutes)

Section A - Word bank

Select one word for each blank. Each word may be used only once.

A weather forecast is often treated as a promise. Rain on a supposedly dry day may therefore seem like a failure. Yet a forecast represents a judgment about possible outcomes, rather than a __(26)__ that one will happen.

Modern forecasting begins with observations from many sources. These measurements provide only a __(27)__ picture of the atmosphere: instruments cannot record conditions at every point. Small differences in the starting information may become more __(28)__ as predictions reach into the future.

To deal with this problem, forecasters run a model repeatedly, making __(29)__ changes to its starting conditions. If the results remain similar, confidence in a particular outcome may increase. If they differ widely, the disagreement itself is __(30)__ information. A single prediction could hide important uncertainty.

This does not mean that all forecasts deserve equal trust. A warning issued before a storm can be based on evidence that was not __(31)__ several days earlier. Nor does uncertainty make preparation pointless. People may reasonably __(32)__ an outdoor event when the possible consequences of severe weather are serious, even if its arrival is not certain.

The challenge is therefore to __(33)__ uncertainty without making the message so complicated that it becomes useless. A percentage needs explanation, and a warning should make clear which area and time it concerns. Better understanding allows users to make decisions that __(34)__ both the likelihood of an event and the cost of being unprepared. The forecast then becomes a tool for judgment, rather than a test of whether somebody can __(35)__ the future perfectly.

A. account	B. available	C. communicate
D. complete	E. guarantee	F. partial
G. postpone	H. predict	I. replace
J. significant	K. slight	L. steadily
M. temporary	N. valuable	O. weigh

Section B - Matching

Identify the paragraph containing each statement. A paragraph may be chosen more than once.

A different view from the old railway line

A) I expected the village railway walk to begin with a story about steam engines. Instead, our guide, Mrs Lin, asked us to look at a row of shallow marks in a stone wall. They had been left by ropes used to pull loaded carts towards the former station, yet we had walked past them on our way from the bus without noticing anything unusual. Her question changed the scale of the visit: the route would not simply take us between impressive buildings, but invite us to read ordinary surfaces.

B) The railway had once carried tea and timber from the surrounding hills. After freight services ended, parts of the track were removed and the station became a storehouse; a proposal to turn the whole line into a cycle route was discussed, but several narrow sections would have required major rebuilding. The walking route that eventually opened retained the older bridges and included short diversions where the original line was unsafe. Its slightly uneven path was part of the experience, though suitable shoes were essential. A few surviving rails were displayed at stopping points rather than used as the walking surface.

C) Although the printed map showed a single continuous route, on the ground it was divided into three loops connected by the village square. Mrs Lin explained that visitors often arrived with very different amounts of time. A family waiting for an afternoon bus could complete the shortest loop, while walkers with a full day could continue into the hills. None of the shorter choices required an awkward return along exactly the same path.

D) Our first stop was the old weighing room. The large scale was still there, but the most revealing object was a notebook beside it, copies of whose pages showed how the amount recorded for the same cart could change after damaged packaging was removed. An elderly former clerk had helped explain the figures. Without his account, the columns would have looked like a dull list of numbers rather than evidence of decisions made during a busy working day.

E) Farther along, a low building contained recordings of former railway workers. Although I initially wished there were more dramatic photographs, a voice soon described the difficulty of hearing a colleague through the noise of unloading. Another speaker remembered the silence after the last train had gone. Neither recording offered a complete history. Together they gave the buildings a human scale that the dates on the information boards could not provide. Visitors could listen through handsets, so several accounts could be heard in the same room without competing with one another.

F) The route crossed a stream beside a recently repaired footbridge. Its new wooden surface looked older than it was because the builders had avoided a bright protective finish. Because this had led some visitors to suppose that the bridge was original, a small notice now explained which parts had been replaced and why. Keeping the appearance of an old structure, Mrs Lin said, should not mean concealing the work that made it safe to cross.

G) At the next junction our group spread out. Several people climbed a short flight of steps for a view of the valley, while others remained on a level path. Although I had worried that choosing the easier way would mean missing an important part of the story, both paths reached the same picnic area, where the main information panels were placed. The climb offered a different view rather than access to essential material denied to everyone else.

H) Lunch was served in the former station kitchen. The menu used vegetables from farms nearby, although the owner was careful about the word local. Since rice, for instance, came from another county and some ingredients were unavailable in winter, she preferred to say where things came from rather

than promise that every item had travelled only a few kilometres. The meal was simple, but this explanation made the account of village food more convincing.

I) In the afternoon we passed a workshop where an artist used discarded railway metal. I admired a small bird made from a bent fastening, but the artist pointed to a shelf of objects she would not cut up. Some pieces carried numbers that could help identify where they had been used; before accepting material from the site, she asked the local archive whether it should be kept. Giving old objects a new life did not require treating all of them as equally disposable.

J) Near the tunnel, mobile reception disappeared. The visitor website contained an audio description, but I could not open it. Fortunately, the route booklet included the same essential information and a simple diagram stood at the entrance; Mrs Lin said that the booklet had survived several attempts to replace it entirely with phone-based material. A technology that worked well in the village square did not necessarily work equally well along the whole line.

K) We reached the upper station later than planned because a shower had slowed us down. I assumed that the small exhibition there would already be closed. In fact, its opening hours followed the last returning shuttle rather than the working hours of the village office, an arrangement agreed with the drivers and explained in a notice listing the final departure time. It allowed walkers to look around without having to choose between the exhibition and their journey home. On days without a shuttle, the exhibition used a shorter schedule, clearly printed on the route map.

L) Back in the square, I bought a postcard showing the station before the railway closed. The roofs looked familiar, yet the space between them was full of people and goods rather than visitors carrying cameras. The walk had not restored that vanished activity, nor had it turned the village into a fixed picture of the past. It had given me a way to connect details I could see with lives I could only partly imagine. I left noticing marks on walls that would previously have escaped my attention.

36. Visitors with limited time could follow a complete circuit rather than retrace their steps.

37. A repair was explained so that an old appearance would not be mistaken for wholly original construction.

38. An account from a former employee helped visitors understand the practical meaning of written records.

39. Some discarded items were preserved because their markings could provide historical information.

40. The daily closing arrangement took account of visitors' available transport.

41. A printed alternative remained useful where a digital resource could not be accessed.

42. The guide drew attention to traces of work that the author had initially overlooked.

43. The provider acknowledged that not every ingredient came from the immediate area.

44. Two paths offered different levels of physical effort without separating visitors from the main explanations.

45. Personal memories supplied a dimension that historical dates alone could not convey.

Section C - Passage 1

Retailers can advertise free delivery without making delivery cost nothing. Packing, transport and the final journey to a customer's door still require resources. What changes is the way in which those costs are covered. They may be included in product prices, covered by a subscription (订阅) or absorbed by a seller expecting future business.

Consider an imaginary experiment involving two otherwise identical online shops. One advertises a lamp at 80 yuan and adds a delivery charge of 10 yuan. The other offers the same lamp for 90 yuan with delivery included. Buying one lamp costs the same at either shop. Nevertheless, the inclusive offer may feel more attractive because the additional charge interrupts a decision the customer has already begun to regard as complete.

This preference does not mean that customers cannot add. A separate fee can be seen as an obstacle imposed by the seller, whereas an inclusive price simplifies the purchase. However, that convenience becomes questionable when customers must reach a minimum order value. Adding an unnecessary product to qualify for free delivery can produce spending greater than the charge being avoided.

A delivery subscription may nevertheless provide genuine savings. For people making frequent small orders, the arrangement can be economical, provided that product prices are competitive and membership does not encourage additional purchases. An occasional customer faces a different calculation: an annual payment for a service used twice cannot be assessed in the same way as one used every week. Comparing delivery charges alone neglects these differences.

The relevant question is therefore not whether an advertisement contains the word free, but what the consumer would spend on purchases already intended. This requires a comparison of total spending and a realistic account of personal shopping habits. Separately charged delivery is not necessarily the worse arrangement, just as an inclusive price is not automatically deceptive. The presentation of a price deserves attention, but it should not substitute for examining what is actually being purchased.

46. What does the opening paragraph emphasise about free delivery?

- A) Its expense is recovered mainly through future price increases.
- B) Its cost is covered through some part of the business arrangement.
- C) Its expense is generally lower than customers expect.
- D) Its cost is usually shared equally by seller and buyer.

47. Why may the second shop's offer feel more attractive in the example?

- A) It presents the delivery saving before the goods are selected.
- B) It gives customers a lower total when they buy a single item.
- C) It avoids a separate charge interrupting the sense of completing a purchase.
- D) It lets customers imagine a better-quality product for the price.

48. What risk is associated with a minimum order for free delivery?

- A) Customers may buy something they do not need to avoid a smaller charge.
- B) Sellers may charge for delivery even when the condition is met.
- C) Customers may receive fewer goods than the stated minimum.
- D) Sellers may raise membership fees as the order becomes larger.

49. When can a delivery membership benefit a frequent shopper?

- A) When each order reaches the minimum required for free delivery.
- B) When its savings are not offset by higher prices or extra purchases.
- C) When the membership is used to increase the number of small orders.
- D) When the shopper buys from several different online retailers.

50. What does the author recommend when comparing delivery offers?

- A) Choose an inclusive price to avoid uncertain future expenses.
- B) Calculate overall spending in relation to intended shopping habits.
- C) Prefer a separate charge when the goods are bought infrequently.
- D) Compare membership fees before considering the prices of goods.

Section C - Passage 2

Trees planted along a city street are often judged by what can be seen above ground. A healthy-looking trunk and a broad crown suggest that the planting has succeeded. Yet the space available beneath the pavement can be just as important to a tree's future as the branches that shade the road.

In a fictional neighbourhood renewal project, planners proposed replacing several small trees with larger ones. Residents welcomed the promise of immediate shade. However, an inspection showed that the original planting holes were surrounded by tightly packed material and underground pipes. A larger tree placed in the same restricted space might look impressive at first without remaining healthy for long.

The project team changed its plan. Instead of increasing the size of every new tree, it joined some planting areas beneath the pavement, allowing roots access to a wider volume of soil. This required coordination with people responsible for water pipes and other services. The work was less visible than lifting a mature tree into place, and it could not be completed everywhere along the street. Where essential services left insufficient room, the designers kept a smaller planting area and selected trees suited to it. This made a uniform appearance less important than choosing a workable arrangement for each location.

Nor did the team assume that more growing space would solve every problem. Different tree species respond differently to heat and water, and newly planted trees still need care while they become established. Residents were asked to report damaged supports or dry planting areas. These observations supplemented professional inspections rather than replacing them.

The revised project illustrates a difficulty in judging public improvements. A photograph taken on opening day favours changes that are immediately visible. The conditions that allow those changes to last may remain hidden. This does not make appearance unimportant: shade and an attractive street are real benefits. It does mean that the success of planting should be assessed over time, including whether the trees remain healthy, rather than solely by their size when the work is announced.

51. What limitation of judging street trees does the author identify?

- A) The size of the crown gives little indication of the shade provided.
- B) The appearance of mature trees matters less to residents than planners.
- C) Above-ground changes cannot be compared at different times.
- D) Visible growth can conceal inadequate conditions below the surface.

52. Why did the team reconsider replacing small trees with larger ones?

- A) The underground pipes had been damaged by the existing trees.
- B) The trees already present were providing sufficient shade.
- C) Residents preferred improvements that could be completed gradually.
- D) The existing underground space might not support their lasting health.

53. What did joining some planting areas involve?

- A) Working with those responsible for other underground facilities.
- B) Removing services from the whole length of the street.
- C) Replacing larger trees with smaller ones throughout the neighbourhood.
- D) Giving all newly planted trees the same quantity of soil.

54. What role were residents expected to play after planting?

- A) Provide observations that would add to specialist monitoring.
- B) Decide which species would best tolerate local heat.
- C) Carry out routine inspections instead of professionals.
- D) Take responsibility for identifying every underground problem.

55. What is the main point of the final paragraph?

- A) Opening-day photographs prevent residents from judging improvements.
- B) Durability requires a broader assessment than immediate visual impact.
- C) Public projects should prioritise hidden work over visible benefits.
- D) The size of newly planted trees is an unreliable measure of their age.

Part IV Translation (30 minutes)

Translate the following passage from Chinese into English. Write your answer on a separate answer sheet.

中国的传统戏曲融合了音乐、舞蹈和表演，具有鲜明的地方特色。过去，人们常在节庆期间聚集在露天戏台前看戏，年轻观众也由此了解历史故事。如今，一些剧团在保留传统表演形式的同时，尝试通过短视频吸引更多年轻人。许多学校还邀请演员走进课堂，介绍戏曲知识。通过这些努力，这门古老的艺术正以新的方式融入现代生活。

End of the question booklet.